a, de, desde, en

Short words, big jobs. Picture where things start, where they go and where they sit.

desde
from · since



Enviando amor **desde** California.
Sending love from California.

de
of · from



Soy **de** California. · la casa **de** Ana
I'm from California. · Ana's house

a
to · toward



Voy **a** Ámsterdam.
I'm going to Amsterdam.

en
in · on · at



Estoy **en** casa.
I'm at home.

hasta
until · up to



desde lunes **hasta** viernes
from Monday to Friday

TWO MORE RULES

Voy **al** mercado. · la casa **del** señor
a + el = al, de + el = del (always joined)

Veo **a** Ana.
I see Ana. (a goes before a person who receives the action)

Why "desde" and not "de"? The love is travelling, and **desde** marks where the trip starts. "De California" is heard too, but it leans toward *belonging to* or *coming from* California.

SOURCES

- RAE–ASALE, Nueva gramática básica de la lengua española (2011): prepositions; the contractions al and del; a before a direct object that is a person.
- RAE–ASALE, Diccionario panhispánico de dudas (2005), entries "a" and "desde".